

Baseball At Hand For U.T. El Paso

By MARK LEIBSON
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Well, football season has just concluded its overextended schedule, basketball and hockey are at full stride and already baseball is upon us.

That's right. Mark the date of Friday Feb. 14, 1975 as the official start of The University of Texas at El Paso's baseball opener against Texas Tech's Red Raiders.

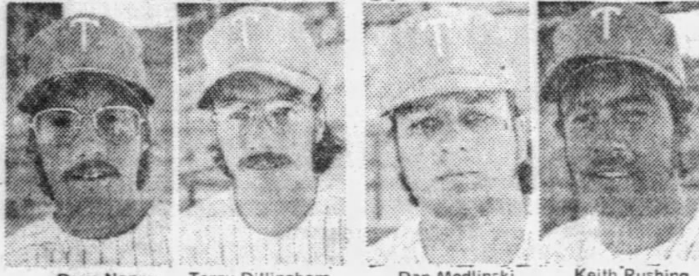
Don't tell some of the eastern universities who are cancelling indoor basketball games left and right due to heavy snow that the Miners and Raiders plan an outdoor activity because a heard of students would trample the desert prairie in search of warm climate.

Weather conditions are excellent for Friday's 1 p.m. doubleheader at Dudley Field but Manager Andy Cohen's scouting report on Texas Tech is far less than Cohen would like.

"To be honest, I don't know a thing about Texas Tech. I hear they have good pitching but I don't know a lot about the hitters," he said as he worked the diamondmen through their final workout prior to the season opener. "We've played Tech in the past and I can tell you one thing they'll have some dandy hitters."

On the contrary Tech Manager Kal Segrist also has a blank note pad which was intended to obtain vital information concerning U.T. El Paso.

Segrist might look at starting pitcher Dan Modlinski's 1974 record of 3-6 with a 7.61 earned run average and laugh. But what Segrist doesn't know is that Cohen has enough confidence in his senior righthander



Dave Nance

Terry Dillingham

Dan Modlinski

Keith Rushing

from Chicago to start Modlinski in Friday's opener.

"Modlinski has been pitching real well for us and I'm expecting a good job out of him," praised Cohen. "I'm not looking for any of our pitchers to go the entire way but Modlinski will get quite a workout."

Ron Wrobel is slated to start the second game.

"Saturday we'll have Roy Stringer and George Landreth starting the two games on the mound for us. When these pitchers get tired, we'll have Bob Knox and Jeff Hogan in relief plus lefthanders Steve Dau and freshman Bob Alsop."

Comparing the Miners to a year ago, Cohen speculated. "We're a much better balanced team thanks to our pitching staff. I'm hoping that our pitching will carry us this season."

Hitting continues to keep Cohen restless at nights and when he finally falls asleep, he dreams of guys like Keith Rushing Joe Pennies Glenn Villarreal and others hitting balls out of Dudley Field.

"We're a little bit behind schedule" admitted Cohen "due to bad weather about a week ago. We are six days behind on our fundamentals. But from what I understand, Tech has also had weather problems in Lubbock."

The lineup will have Art Bravo, a freshman from Austin High, leading off at second fol-

lowed by right fielder Steve Dau with third baseman Villarreal batting in the No. 3 position.

Catcher Joe Dehn will be at cleanup with Stringer filling in the designated hitter's role. Centerfielder Pennies is sixth in the lineup followed by Rushing at Right, Terry Dillingham at first and Dave Nance at shortstop.

In the nightcap, Cohen plans to replace Bravo at second with Allan Morris, send Wayne Larson behind the plate and possibly use John Hahn at first.

Cohen has a total of 15 returning lettermen back from last year's 24-27 overall record and 2-16 mark in the tough Southern Division of the Western Athletic Conference. Texas Tech was 11-22 overall last year and finished seventh in Southwest Conference play with a 9-15 standing.

A couple of familiar faces will be traveling with Tech into El Paso. Former Burges shortstop Noah Castle and Austin pitcher Dave Runkel have joined the Raiders and are expected to see a lot of action against the Miners.

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